

A COMPARATIVE METHODOLOGY FOR MEASURING SUPPLY-SIDE DOMESTIC PAYMENT COSTS

RESULTS FROM A PILOT STUDY

Oya Ardic, Holti Banka,
Yanning Chen and Edlira Dashi



FINANCE, COMPETITIVENESS & INVESTMENTS GLOBAL PRACTICE

Payment Systems Development Group

© 2025 International Bank for Reconstruction and Development / The World Bank
1818 H Street NW
Washington DC 20433
Telephone: 202-473-1000
Internet: www.worldbank.org

This volume is a product of the staff of the World Bank. The findings, interpretations, and conclusions expressed in this volume do not necessarily reflect the views of the Executive Directors of the World Bank or the governments they represent.

The World Bank does not guarantee the accuracy of the data included in this work. The boundaries, colors, denominations, and other information shown on any map in this work do not imply any judgment on the part of the World Bank concerning the legal status of any territory or the endorsement or acceptance of such boundaries.

RIGHTS AND PERMISSIONS

The material in this publication is subject to copyright. Because the World Bank encourages dissemination of their knowledge, this work may be reproduced, in whole or in part, for noncommercial purposes as long as full attribution is given.

www.fastpayments.worldbank.org

ACKNOWLEDGMENTS

The authors would like to thank Harish Natarajan (Practice Manager) for his overall guidance, as well as Aart Kraay (Chief Economist), and members of the Payment Systems Development Group for their feedback. In particular, the authors would like to thank Xavier Gine, Alexander Pankov, and Matthew Saal (all World Bank Group) for their useful comments during the formal peer reviewing process. FXC Intelligence collected the underlying data.

TABLE OF CONTENTS

01 INTRODUCTION

02 METHODOLOGY AND DATA COLLECTION

- 2.1 Monitoring and Evaluation
- 2.2 Cash Withdrawal
- 2.3 P2P Payments
- 2.4 P2B Payments
- 2.5 Transaction Size
- 2.6 Challenges and Limitations

03 ANALYSIS AND RESULTS

- 3.1 Transaction Account Access Costs
- 3.2 Cash Withdrawal Costs
- 3.3 P2P Payment Costs
- 3.4 P2B Payment Costs

04 CONCLUSION

ANNEX I PROVIDERS BY COUNTRY

ANNEX II GLOSSARY





INTRODUCTION

The cost of domestic payments affects individuals, businesses, and economies alike. Everyday transactions, such as paying a vendor, sending money to a family member, settling a bill, may seem routine, but in many emerging markets and developing economies (EMDEs), the cost of these payments remains a barrier to full financial participation. High payment costs, particularly for digital transactions, reinforce dependence on cash, limit access to formal financial services, and ultimately constrain economic opportunity and resilience.

Digital payments are a gateway to inclusion, if they are affordable and accessible. Person-to-person (P2P) and person-to-business (P2B) payments are among the most frequent financial transactions for individuals and small enterprises. P2P digital payments allow people to manage expenses, support others, and transfer funds quickly, including between their own accounts. P2B digital payments underpin small-scale commerce, entrepreneurship, and daily consumption. These use cases are expanding rapidly¹, driven by wider smartphone and internet access, the rise in fast payment infrastructures, overlay services such as QR codes and aliases, and the evolution of open finance ecosystems.

In this context, understanding the cost of domestic payments is critical to increasing usage and designing effective reforms. For low-income individuals and small businesses, even modest fees can deter the use of formal payment services. Measuring these costs helps identify specific frictions that hinder access and uptake of financial services, particularly digital ones. This evidence is essential for designing policies that enhance transparency, lower transaction costs, and promote more inclusive financial ecosystems. It also supports product development that better reflects users' actual needs and behaviors.

The World Bank has been measuring the cost of retail payments for more than a decade. In 2016, it introduced a comprehensive framework for collecting demand (consumers and businesses)- and supply (payment service providers)-side data on domestic retail payments². Implemented in 11 countries to date, the framework provides a detailed snapshot of payment costs by use case, payment instrument, channel, and economic actor, as well as potential savings from shifting to more efficient digital methods³. In parallel, the World Bank maintains the Remittance Prices Worldwide⁴ database, the most comprehensive public resource on cross-border P2P transfer costs globally. More recently, Project FASTT (Frictionless, Affordable, Safe, Timely Transactions) has examined factors influencing the cost structure of domestic fast payments⁵.

¹ Fast payments, also known as instant, real-time, immediate, are characterized by instant crediting of the payee's account and 24/7/365 availability of service.

² A Practical Guide for Measuring Retail Payment Costs (2016). World Bank.

<https://documents1.worldbank.org/curated/en/255851482286959215/pdf/Retail-Payments-A-Practical-Guide-for-Measuring-Retail-Payment-Costs.pdf>

³ Albania, Bangladesh, Guyana, Indonesia, Kosovo, Malaysia, Morocco, Myanmar, Palestine, Pakistan (partial), Tonga.

⁴ Please see <https://remittanceprices.worldbank.org/> for World Bank's Remittance Prices Worldwide database.

⁵ Further information about World Bank's Project FASTT can be found at: <https://fastpayments.worldbank.org/>

Building on these existing methodologies, the World Bank has developed a supply-side framework to estimate domestic payment costs charged by providers in a standardized and globally comparable way. The framework focuses on three dimensions:

1. Account access costs – the cost of opening a transaction account;
2. Cash withdrawal costs – the cost of withdrawing funds from a digital (especially e-money⁶) account (as a proxy for the cost of cash usage); and
3. Digital payments usage costs – the fees charged for P2P and P2B digital payments.



Standardized transaction values and parameters ensure comparability across providers, countries, and over time. To test the approach, the World Bank partnered with FXC Intelligence in 2023 to collect data in six countries: Brazil, Colombia, India, Nigeria, Thailand, and the United Kingdom. These countries were selected to reflect diversity in terms of geography, income levels, population size, and maturity of payment ecosystems. The pilot provides a reference point for future global monitoring efforts and offers new insights into payment system performance, cost drivers, and reform opportunities.

⁶ Given the role of mobile money in driving financial inclusion in Africa and elsewhere, mobile money is analyzed as a separate category from other types of e-money accounts. Thus e-money accounts include all e-money accounts except mobile money accounts.



METHODOLOGY AND DATA COLLECTION

2

This methodology measures the cost of accessing and using domestic payment services for end users (individuals/consumers and merchants) across six diverse markets. Leading institutions offering domestic payment services were identified in each market to ensure broad representation of the payments ecosystem.

The sample includes traditional banks, digital banks, and e-money providers, covering various account types such as bank accounts, mobile money accounts, and e-money accounts (covering payment products besides mobile money). This diversity of provider type enables a nuanced assessment of cost structures and service offerings across different financial institutions.

For account access, cash withdrawal, and P2P payments, payment service providers (PSPs) were selected based on asset size and market share, using publicly available data where possible. The top banks were chosen according to their asset base, while non-bank PSPs were identified through third-party reports on prominent players and market share data when available.

For P2B payments, providers were identified by examining their market presence, transaction volumes, and merchant networks through third-party sources. The selection focused on merchant acquirers, payment processors, and card networks with the largest transaction volumes or merchant customer bases, ensuring that the analysis captures the most significant players in each market.

In total, the methodology covered 103 providers across the six countries, 56 for account access, cash withdrawal, and P2P payments, and 62⁷ for P2B payments. Collectively, these providers represent approximately 70–75 percent of the market in each country. Adopting a provider perspective, the study collected standardized data on costs and related service parameters to enable robust cross-country comparability and to inform future efforts to monitor the affordability of domestic payments globally.

Data sources included publicly available fee schedules, FAQs, and product information from provider websites, complemented by third-party reports and industry analyses. This comprehensive data collection strategy ensures that the study provides a detailed and accurate representation of cost structures across different provider types and markets.

2.1

Transaction Account Access

Access costs refer to the one-time fees charged for opening a transaction account, a critical factor influencing financial inclusion, particularly for individuals entering the formal financial system for the first time⁸. Analyzing these costs provides insights into the initial costs faced by consumers when opening and maintaining access to transaction accounts, highlighting potential barriers to entry and affordability differences across provider types.

Data were collected from 56 PSPs, including traditional banks, digital banks, and e-money providers, covering a range

⁷ Excluding card networks.

⁸ Access costs also include regular account maintenance costs charged by PSPs. For this pilot, maintenance costs were not collected (with the exception of a few cases noted in Section 4.1) as the types of accounts included in the pilot did not have such costs.

of account types such as bank accounts, mobile-money accounts, and e-money accounts (Table 1)⁹. The data collection captured all applicable combinations of provider and account types, recognizing that some combinations may not exist in every jurisdiction. For example, a traditional bank may offer both bank and e-money accounts, while an e-money provider typically offers only e-money accounts.

Table 1 - List of provider and account types for which transaction account access cost data is collected

ACCESS COSTS	
PSP Type	Account Type
- Traditional bank - Digital Bank - E-money provider	- Bank account - Mobile money account - E-money account

2.2 Cash Withdrawal

The pilot also captured costs associated with withdrawing cash transaction accounts, expressed as a percentage of the value withdrawn¹⁰. Understanding these costs is essential, as they influence users' decisions to convert digital balances into cash and can reflect broader frictions in the transition toward digital financial ecosystems.

Data were collected from 56 PSPs across six markets, encompassing traditional banks, digital banks, and e-money providers. The analysis covers mobile-money and e-money accounts, capturing all applicable provider-account combinations (Table 2). Not all combinations exist in every market; for example, e-money providers typically do not offer bank accounts, while some banks may provide e-money-type wallets.

Table 2 - List of provider and account types for which cash withdrawal cost data is collected

CASH WITHDRAWAL COSTS	
PSP Type	Account Type
- Traditional bank - Digital Bank - E-money provider	- Mobile money account - E-money account

⁹ The category "bank account" includes basic savings bank accounts in India, transactional/current accounts in Nigeria, and current accounts in Brazil, Colombia, Thailand and the UK. E-money accounts include all e-money accounts except mobile money accounts, which are analyzed separately.

¹⁰ The transaction value derived for the P2P use case is used as a proxy for the standard value of the amount withdrawn. Please see section 2.5 for details.

2.3 P2P Payments

Data on P2P payments measures the fees charged to customers for domestic person-to-person digital transfers, covering both intra-PSP (both, the payer and payee have accounts with the same provider) and inter-PSP transactions (the payer and payee have accounts with different providers). P2P payments are among the most frequent financial transactions for individuals and serve as a key proxy for the accessibility, affordability, and efficiency of domestic payment systems.

Data were collected from traditional banks, digital banks, and e-money providers, covering three types of accounts used to initiate transfers (bank accounts, mobile-money accounts, and e-money accounts). The dataset captures both in-person and remote transactions, processed either as intra-PSP or as inter-PSP. Fees are expressed as a percentage of the transaction value, allowing comparison across countries and providers.

Data on P2P payments also include information on the transaction channel, payment system, and transaction speed. Channels encompass both in-person and remote options (e.g., internet banking, mobile apps, Unstructured Supplementary Service Data (USSD), or call centers). Payment systems include fast payment systems (FPS), automated clearing houses (ACH), e-money switches, and real-time gross settlement systems (RTGS). Transaction speed refers to the time required for funds to become accessible to the recipient, ranging from instant to multi-day settlement.

The dataset encompasses all relevant combinations of provider type, account type, transaction channel, transfer type, payment system, and transaction speed, recognizing that not all combinations exist in every market. For example, some e-money providers may not support ACH-based payments or in-person transfers, while certain banks may not offer USSD channels.

Data were compiled from publicly available sources, including fee schedules, FAQs, and product information from provider websites, complemented by third-party reports and industry analyses. For banks, data were collected for the most accessible account types, determined by minimum balance requirements or account opening costs, depending on the market.

Table 3 - List of providers, account, transfer, channel types and transaction speeds for which P2P payment cost data is collected

P2P PAYMENT COSTS						
PSP Type	Initiating Account Type	Transfer Type	Transaction Channel	Receiving Payment Method	Payment System	Speed
- Traditional bank - Digital Bank - E-money provider	- Bank account - Mobile money account - E-money account	- Inter-PSP - Intra-PSP	- In-person - Bank branch - Remote - Internet - Mobile app - Call center - USSD¹¹	- Bank account - Mobile money account - E-money account	- Fast Payment System (FPS) - Automated Clearing House (ACH) - E-money switch - Real Time Gross Settlement System (RTGS)	- Instant - Non-instant 2 hours - Same day - Next day 1-2 days

¹¹ USSD stands for Unstructured Supplementary Service Data and is a protocol used for text messages.

2.4 P2B Payments

Data on P2B payments measure the fees charged by providers to merchants for receiving domestic digital payments from customers. Costs associated with P2B transactions are typically borne by the payee or merchant. These merchant-facing fees, collectively referred to as merchant fees, are a key determinant of payment acceptance and can influence both consumer prices and the overall cost of goods and services.

Data were collected from merchant acquirers, payment processors, and card networks, focusing on per-transaction fees applied to different payment instruments and channels. The analysis covered providers with the largest transaction volumes or merchant customer bases in each market, using publicly available data and third-party reports where available.

The dataset captures several parameters, including PSP type, merchant category, payment method, transaction channel, payment system, and speed of fund availability. Payment methods include credit transfers, debit and credit cards, e-money accounts, and cash-voucher systems. Channels encompass both in-person and remote transactions, while payment systems range from fast payment systems for instant transfers to other clearing and settlement mechanisms with processing times from within two hours to several days (Table 4).

The dataset includes all relevant permutations of provider, payment method, transaction channel, payment system, and transaction speed, recognizing that not all combinations exist in every market. For instance, some e-money providers may not participate in ACH-based clearing, while certain merchant acquirers may not process FPS transactions.

For card-based payments, the study examined the merchant discount rate (MDR), which is expressed as a percentage of the amount paid and typically consists of three components:

- *Interchange Fee: fees charged by the card issuing bank (i.e., bank that represents the payer/individual)*
- *Network Fee (also known as scheme fee or assessment fee): fees charged by the card network.*
- *Acquirer Fee: fees charged by the acquirer/processor (i.e., bank/institution that represents the payee/merchant)*

Where MDR data were unavailable, the interchange fee was used as a proxy, as it often accounts for the majority (up to 70 percent) of total merchant fees¹². Depending on the provider and market, MDRs may be charged as a flat fee or as a percentage of the transaction value, sometimes with minimum or maximum thresholds. Pricing models for payment acceptance services vary significantly across countries and providers, which introduces complexity when benchmarking costs. The analysis focuses solely on per-transaction fees, excluding one-time costs such as point-of-sale (POS) terminal rental or installation. For non-card instruments (e.g., bank transfers or e-wallets), data were collected on the total merchant fee charged by the provider.

Merchant categories were also analyzed, as interchange and acquirer fees may vary by business type. The study prioritized merchant categories representing everyday consumer spending, such as groceries, restaurants, fuel stations, and small retail outlets, reflecting common domestic payment use cases.

The speed of P2B payments refers to the time required for funds to become available to merchants, ranging from instant settlement in FPS to multi-day transfers in traditional systems.

¹² https://ec.europa.eu/commission/presscorner/detail/it/MEMO_07_590

Table 4 - List of sending payment method types, transaction channels and transaction speeds for which P2B payment cost data is collected

P2B PAYMENTS ¹³		
Sending Payment Method	Transaction Channel	Speed and Payment System
- Credit transfer - Cash-voucher - Credit card - Debit Card - E-money account	- In-person - Remote	- Instant (through Fast Payment Systems) - Other systems - Within 2 hours - Same day - Next day - 2 days - 3-5 days - 6 days or more

2.5 Transaction Size

Payment transaction costs are expressed as a percentage of the transaction value¹⁴, a critical factor for understanding the cost dynamics of domestic payments. This is because PSPs' pricing schedules are mostly based on a different flat fee corresponding to each transaction size bucket. PSPs do not have information on the purpose of transactions. Thus, it is not possible to understand the purpose of a transaction using only supply-side data. At this stage, additional information from demand-side data, which are less frequently collected as they are more expensive and complicated to do so, can be helpful. For example, household surveys or payment diaries can provide useful information on average transaction size for specific purposes, which can then be combined with supply-side data to assign transaction size buckets for specific purposes such as P2P transfers or merchant payments (e.g. P2B).

To ensure comparability across countries and over time, standardized transaction sizes were developed based on U.S. market data and then adjusted for differences in income levels and purchasing power.

- The P2P transaction size is set at USD 180. This is the average dollar value per mobile payment app transaction¹⁵ obtained from the Federal Reserve Bank of Atlanta's 2021 Survey and Diary of Consumer Payment Choice¹⁶. This is also used for the cash withdrawal value ticket.
- The P2B transaction size is set at USD 70. This is the average dollar value for debit and credit card payments¹⁷ obtained from the 2021 Federal Reserve Payments Study.¹⁸

As there is no other comparable and annual study for other countries in the dataset for the pilot, these average transaction sizes based on the US payments market are used to develop the average transaction sizes for the countries

¹³ In some cases, payment transactions can happen instantly even for other (non-fast) payment systems, due to existing bilateral agreements between providers, though not a default characteristic of non-fast payment systems. Several such services are included in the database.

¹⁴ See, for example, World Bank's Remittance Prices Worldwide database: <https://remittanceprices.worldbank.org/>

¹⁵ USD 181.40 was rounded to the nearest ten.

¹⁶ https://www.atlantafed.org/-/media/documents/banking/consumer-payments/survey-diary-consumer-payment-choice/2021/tables_dcp_c2021.pdf

¹⁷ USD 69.50 rounded to the nearest ten.

¹⁸ <https://www.federalreserve.gov/paymentsystems/fr-payments-study.htm>

in the pilot. The methodology proposes a scaling factor with the ratio of each country's GDP per capita scaled for purchasing power parity to that of the US multiplied by the exchange rate of the local currency unit (LCU) to USD. GDP per capita scaled for purchasing power parity is used to account for the difference in purchasing power across countries. This approach will also be critical while constructing a global database, as it is not common to have such studies on retail payments transaction sizes readily available. Accordingly, the scaling factor for Country X is expressed as:

$$\text{Scaling Factor}_X = \left(\frac{\text{GDP per capita, PPP}_X}{\text{GDP per capita, PPP}_{\text{USA}}} \right) \times \text{Exchange Rate}_{X, \text{USD}}$$

The transaction size (in USD) is converted to local currency unit (LCU) equivalent using the scaling factor expressed as above, and the converted value for each country is expressed as:

$$\text{Transaction Size}_X = \text{USD Value} \times \text{Scaling Factor}_X$$

where the USD value is USD 180 for P2P payments and USD 70 for P2B payments. Table 5 presents the resulting scaling factors and transaction sizes for P2P and P2B payment transactions for the six countries included in this study.

In this study and dataset, the exchange rates used are the average rates for the first six months of 2023 and the data on the six countries was also collected during the first half of 2023.¹⁹ Overall, this approach ensures continuity (given that the US data is gathered every year through surveys), and comparability across countries and across time.

Table 5 - List of provider and account types for which cash withdrawal cost data is collected

COUNTRY	Scaling factor	P2P transaction size (\$180 equivalent)	P2P transaction size (\$180 equivalent)
BRAZIL	1.17	BRL 210	BRL 80
COLOMBIA	1,120.01	COP 201,600	COP 78,400
INDIA	8.59	INR 1,550	INR 600
NIGERIA	35.98	GNG 6,480	NGN 2,520
THAILAND	9.26	THB 1,670	THB 650
UNITED KINGDOM	0.6	GBP 110	GBP 40

U.S. retail payment data are collected annually, disaggregated by use case, and based on robust consumer surveys—making them a reliable reference point in the absence of comparable, high-frequency datasets elsewhere. By adjusting these values using GDP per capita (PPP) and exchange rates, this approach accounts for differences in income levels, purchasing power, and local currency value, enabling meaningful cost comparisons across diverse markets.

¹⁹ If similar data is collected in the future for the same countries as well as others, the exchange rates for the most recent periods can be used to account for significant currency fluctuations, and to ensure comparability.

2.6 Challenges and Limitations

While the framework represents the first of its kind, it has some limitations. Using a single representative transaction value per use case cannot fully capture the diversity of payment behavior across income levels, transaction purposes, or market segments. Because many PSPs apply tiered fee structures, small differences in assumed transaction size can shift results substantially across fee brackets. Furthermore, the reliance on U.S. benchmarks presumes similarity in transaction patterns that may not hold in emerging or cash-dominant economies. In addition, the approach implicitly assumes an “average” consumer, overlooking income inequality and differing consumption patterns that may affect transaction size distributions.

The pilot study also encountered several challenges in gathering data predominantly on P2B transactions, particularly in terms of transparency around pricing and speed, due to a variety of factors listed below.

Payment processing for P2B transactions involves multiple parties, each levying a commission. These commissions are sometimes bundled into a single charge for the merchant, but not uniformly. In addition, pricing for P2B services is influenced by a variety of factors, including merchant categories and the specific services offered by merchants. However, these factors are not consistently presented across the industry.²⁰

The payment method can also affect the pricing of P2B payments. For card transactions, fees may vary depending on whether the card is premium vs. non-premium or on-us vs. off-us transaction. Quick response (QR) code fast payments, for instance, may incur different fees. These distinctions are not uniformly indicated across PSPs.

Identifying and categorizing the exact payment method to fund the transaction or the transaction channel used can be challenging. Some PSPs offer QR code payments without specifying the underlying payment instrument which funds the transaction, such as card, credit transfer, or e-money, which can result in different fee structures. Additionally, PSPs may not always clearly indicate whether a particular payment method is supported for both remote and in-store purchases, or whether pricing differs between these two transaction channels.

The technology employed in processing payments can further complicate the tracking of pricing. Processors and acquirers may provide various POS terminals, including subscription-based models, with commissions varying by terminal type or subscription plan. Moreover, the cost of a contactless card transaction may differ from that of a ‘Chip and Pin’ transaction.

Alternative Approaches

Alternative approaches were considered for this exercise. One option would be to express the U.S. transaction size as a share of GDP per capita and apply the same ratio to each country’s GDP per capita, thus anchoring transaction values to relative income levels. Another, more sophisticated approach would approximate a distribution of transaction sizes using household income distributions for each country, assuming, for instance, that typical payment sizes are a fixed share of disposable income. Such an approach could then be overlaid with provider fee schedules to model a weighted average transaction cost across the population.

While these alternatives were beyond the scope of this initial data collection, they represent promising avenues for future refinement. Future iterations of the methodology could integrate income-distribution data or national demand-side surveys to construct country-specific transaction distributions. This would enhance the sensitivity of cost estimates to local market conditions while preserving global comparability.

²⁰ Merchant Category Codes (MCC), which can number in the hundreds, differ among providers, countries, and card networks, add to the complexity.

ANALYSIS AND RESULTS

The study revealed significant differences in costs, speed, and transparency across the six markets, illustrating both progress and persistent barriers in the journey toward affordable, inclusive payment systems. While access to basic accounts has become nearly universal and free, the cost of using and accepting payments continues to vary widely depending on the provider, payment method, and infrastructure. Together, these findings provide a snapshot of how market structure, competition, and technology influence the affordability of financial services.

3.1 Transaction Account Access Costs

For most of the account types analyzed, providers do not charge a fee to open a transaction account. (Table 6). This indicates that the formal cost of entering the system has largely disappeared, reflecting the impact of competition and digital innovation on financial access.

There are, however, notable exceptions. In Nigeria, opening a traditional bank account typically costs 10 NGN (USD 0.28), and some banks also require an opening balance ranging from NGN 2,000 to 10,000. These requirements, though small, can be meaningful barriers for low-income individuals. By contrast, both mobile money and e-money accounts in Nigeria can be opened free of charge, regardless of provider type, suggesting that digital financial service providers are playing an important role in removing access costs and expanding inclusion. Across all markets, the data suggest that the focus of access challenges has shifted from formal fees to indirect barriers, such as minimum balance requirements, documentation, or lack of digital literacy.

Table 6 - Average Cost of Opening an Account, by Type of PSP and Type of Account

COUNTRY	All PSP Types	Traditional Bank	Digital Bank	E-money Provider	Bank account	Mobile money account	E-money account
BRAZIL	\$0.00 (BRL 0.00)	\$0.00 (BRL 0.00)	\$0.00 (BRL 0.00)	\$0.00 (BRL 0.00)	\$0.00 (BRL 0.00)	\$0.00 (BRL 0.00)	\$0.00 (BRL 0.00)
COLOMBIA	\$0.00 (COP 0.00)	\$0.00 (COP 0.00)	\$0.00 (COP 0.00)	\$0.00 (COP 0.00)	\$0.00 (COP 0.00)	\$0.00 (COP 0.00)	\$0.00 (COP 0.00)
INDIA	\$0.00 (INR 0.00)	\$0.00 (INR 0.00)	\$0.00 (INR 0.00)	\$0.00 (INR 0.00)	\$0.00 (INR 0.00)	\$0.00 (INR 0.00)	\$0.00 (INR 0.00)
NIGERIA	\$0.12 (NGN 4.545)	\$0.19 (NGN 7.143)	\$0.00 (NGN 0.00)	\$0.00 (NGN 0.00)	\$0.27 (NGN 10.00)	\$0.00 (NGN 0.00)	\$0.00 (NGN 0.00)
THAILAND	\$0.00 (THB 0.00)	\$0.00 (THB 0.00)	\$0.00 (THB 0.00)	\$0.00 (THB 0.00)	\$0.00 (THB 0.00)	\$0.00 (THB 0.00)	\$0.00 (THB 0.00)
UNITED KINGDOM	\$0.00 (GBP 0.00)	\$0.00 (GBP 0.00)	\$0.00 (GBP 0.00)	\$0.00 (GBP 0.00)	\$0.00 (GBP 0.00)	\$0.00 (GBP 0.00)	\$0.00 (GBP 0.00)

Source: World Bank Domestic Payments Costs Dataset, World Bank and World Bank staff calculations. The table shows simple averages.

Note: Data on access costs was calculated on the local currency amount. The access cost in USD has been calculated by applying the same percent of the equivalent transaction amount in USD.

3.2 Cash Withdrawal Costs

The findings reveal that while digital account opening is free, cashing out still carries a cost for many users. Withdrawal fees remain inconsistent and opaque, with 35 percent of e-money providers not disclosing their withdrawal fees publicly. Among those that do, the range of costs is striking.

Brazil emerges as the most expensive market for withdrawing cash from e-money accounts, with average withdrawal fees of 3.05 percent of the transaction value, followed by Thailand at 2.1 percent (Figure 1). In contrast, most providers in Colombia and Nigeria offer free cash withdrawals, highlighting regional differences in both market practices and regulation. The results also show that banks acting as e-money issuers sometimes impose higher withdrawal fees than dedicated e-money providers.

Withdrawal costs were difficult to compare across provider types, as no withdrawal fees have been disclosed for banks or digital banks that also act as e-money providers, except in the case of withdrawing from banks in Nigeria from a mobile money account (Figure 1). Very few PSPs in Thailand and UK reported withdrawal cost.

The uneven disclosure and variation across countries point to a continuing transparency gap in digital payments. For users who rely on both cash and digital channels, withdrawal costs can represent a real friction in the path toward full digital participation. Reducing these costs, and ensuring providers clearly disclose them, will be essential for maintaining user trust in digital systems.

Figure 1 - Average Withdrawal Cost, by PSP Type²¹ and Account Type

Brazil	3.05%		3.05%		3.05%
Colombia	0.92%		0.92%		0.92%
India					
Nigeria	1.46%	1.54%	1.43%	1.43%	1.54%
Thailand	2.10%		2.10%		2.10%
United Kingdom	0.00%		0.00%		0.00%
All Countries	1.74%	1.54%	1.76%	1.43%	1.82%
	All PSP Types	Traditional Bank	E-Money Provider	Mobile Money Account	E-Money Account

Source: World Bank Domestic Payments Costs Dataset, World Bank and World Bank staff calculations. Figure shows simple averages

Note: Empty cells indicate that no data was reported

²¹ Data on the fees for cash withdrawals for bank accounts are not captured in this report, thus NA means Not Applicable.

3.3

P2P Payment Costs

P2P payments remain a cornerstone of financial inclusion, and their affordability provides a revealing measure of how efficiently payment systems function. Across the six countries, P2P payment costs range from 0 to 4.10 percent of the transaction value, varying by provider, account type, transaction channel, and speed. In almost all markets, inter-PSP transfers are more expensive than intra-PSP transfers, which take place within the same institution. Brazil stands out with high interbank transfer costs of 4.94 percent, while in the United Kingdom, all P2P transfers, including inter-PSP ones, are offered free of charge (Table 7).

E-money accounts tend to have lower or no costs in several countries, suggesting a cost advantage. All transfer types in the UK are offered free of charge for the account and provider types included in the study, including for inter-PSP transactions, indicating a unique market situation, likely due to high competition and regulatory influences.

Table 7 - Average Cost of Sending P2P Transfers by Country & Type of Initiating Account

Country	All Account Types		Bank Account		Mobile Money Account		E-money Account	
	intra-PSP	inter-PSP	intra-PSP	inter-PSP	intra-PSP	inter-PSP	intra-PSP	inter-PSP
Brazil	0.55%	4.10%	0.62%	4.94%	N/A	N/A	0.00%	0.00%
Colombia	0.00%	1.13%	0.00%	1.66%	N/A	N/A	0.00%	0.00%
India	0.00%	0.12%	0.00%	0.08%	N/A	N/A	0.00%	0.56%
Nigeria	0.14%	0.59%	0.13%	0.65%	0.23%	0.72%	0.00%	0.18%
Thailand	0.36%	0.68%	0.48%	0.72%	N/A	N/A	0.00%	0.53%
United Kingdom	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	N/A	N/A	0.00%	0.00%

Source: World Bank Domestic Payments Costs Dataset, World Bank and World Bank staff calculations. The table shows simple averages.

Note: N/A indicates that no data has been reported

Transfers between bank accounts tend to be more expensive than transfers from a bank account to an e-money account, confirming that interoperability and non-bank innovation can drive affordability. Digital banks and e-money providers frequently offer free transfers within their own networks, while some traditional banks in Brazil, Nigeria, and Thailand still charge even for intra-PSP transfers. In India, for instance, the inter-PSP P2P payments offered by banks are cheaper than those offered by e-money providers. In the UK, this service is offered free of charge for the account and provider types included in the pilot.

Table 8 - Average Cost of Sending P2P Transfers, by Country & Type of PSP

Country	Intra-PSP Usage Fee				Inter-PSP Usage Fee			
	Traditional Bank	Digital Bank	E-money Provider	All PSP Type	Traditional Bank	Digital Bank	E-money Provider	All PSP Type
Brazil	0.64%	0.00%	0.00%	0.55%	5.44%	0.00%	0.00%	4.10%
Colombia	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	1.92%	0.00%	0.00%	1.13%
India	0.00%	N/A	0.00%	0.00%	0.08%	N/A	0.56%	0.12%
Nigeria	0.17%	N/A	0.04%	0.14%	0.80%	N/A	0.18%	0.59%
Thailand	0.48%	N/A	0.00%	0.36%	0.72%	N/A	0.53%	0.68%
United Kingdom	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%

Source: World Bank Domestic Payments Costs Dataset, World Bank and World Bank staff calculations. Table shows simple averages.

Note: N/A indicates that no data has been reported.

P2P payment costs also vary across types of accounts used to send and receive the transfer. For example, transfers involving bank account transfers on the sending and receiving end incur a higher cost than sending from a bank account to an e-money account. The first row of Figure 2 displays the account types used to send the transfer, and the second row lists the receiving account type. Not all combinations of the sending account types and receiving accounts are offered/available in each country. For example, bank account-to- e-money account transfers are available only in Brazil and Colombia.

Figure 2 - Average Cost of Sending P2P Transfers by Country & Type of Sending Account & Receiving

Country	All Account types	From Bank Account		From Mobile Money Account		From E-Money Account		
Brazil	4.10%	5.18%	0.00%			0.00%	0.00%	
Colombia	1.13%	1.78%	0.00%			0.00%	0.00%	0.00%
India	0.12%	0.08%				0.84%		0.00%
Nigeria	0.59%	0.68%		1.16%	0.08%	0.39%	0.15%	0.00%
Thailand	0.68%	0.72%				0.70%		0.00%
United Kingdom	0.00%	0.00%						0.00%
	Total	To Bank Account	To E-Money Account	To Bank Account	To Mobile Money Account	To Bank Account	To Mobile Money Account	To E-Money Account

Source: World Bank Domestic Payments Costs Dataset, World Bank and World Bank staff calculations. Figure shows simple averages.

Note: Empty cells indicate that no data was reported.

Channel and speed also play a decisive role. In-person transfers at bank branches are consistently the most expensive, with Brazil showing the highest fees. Conversely, remote transfers initiated via mobile apps, internet banking, or USSD, are significantly cheaper, and India records the lowest costs across all remote channels.

Figure 3 - Average Cost of Sending P2P Transfers by Country & transaction channel (Inter-PSP)

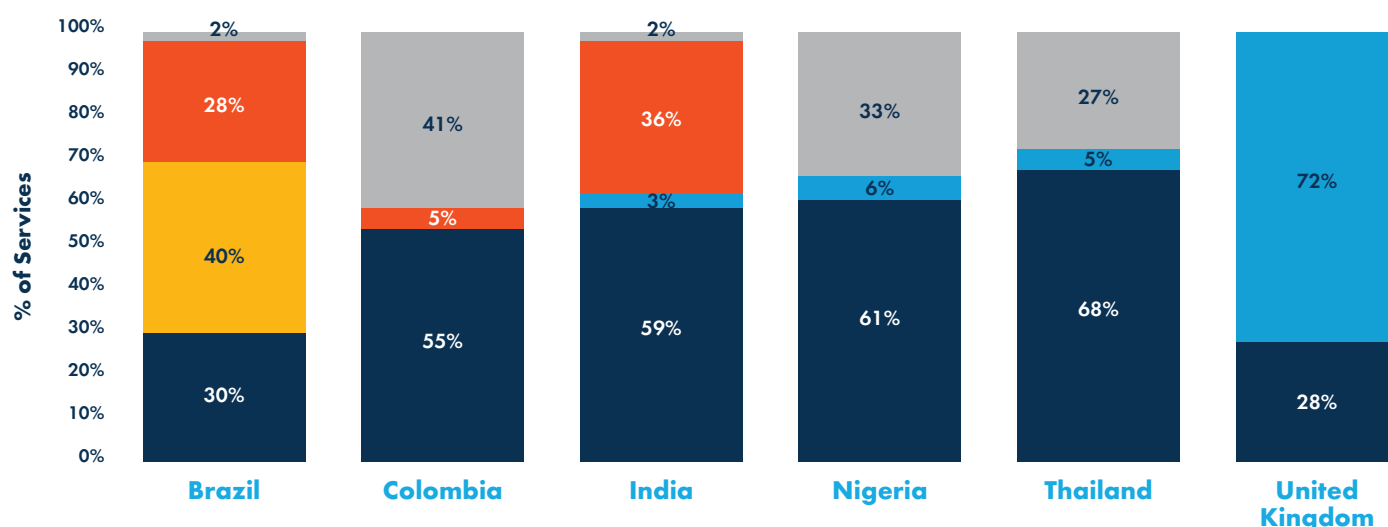
Country	In-person		Remote				
Brazil	10.69%	10.69%	2.57%		2.91%	2.30%	
Colombia	3.42%	3.42%	1.02%		0.83%	1.34%	
India	0.16%	0.16%	0.12%		0.06%	0.17%	
Nigeria			0.59%		0.95%	0.46%	0.62%
Thailand	1.91%	1.91%	0.27%	0.48%	0.00%	0.36%	
United Kingdom	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%		0.00%	0.00%	
	Overall	Bank Branch	Overall	Call Centre	Internet	Mobile App	USSD

Source: World Bank Domestic Payments Costs Dataset, World Bank and World Bank staff calculations. Figure shows simple averages.

Note: Empty cells indicate that no data was reported.

Data on transfer speed remain incomplete: roughly 30 to 40 percent of P2P services in Colombia, Nigeria, and Thailand did not report speed information. Among those that did, the majority of transactions in Colombia, India, Nigeria, and Thailand are processed instantly, while Brazil and the UK show widespread near-real-time transfers.

Figure 4 - Share of P2P Transfer Services by Country & by Speed (Inter-PSP)



Source: World Bank Domestic Payments Costs Dataset, World Bank and World Bank staff calculations. Figure shows simple averages.

Note: NA indicates that no data was reported.

The payment systems that process payment transactions among different payment service providers, and in this case the P2P transactions determine, among others, the level of interoperability, speed, duration of service availability, and cost. In all the piloted countries, the study collected P2P transaction data that are processed by Fast Payment Systems (FPS), among other payment systems.

In this pilot dataset, there is data from FPS in each country: Brazil (Pix), Colombia (Transfiya), Nigeria (NIP), Thailand (PromptPay), UK (Faster Payments Service). Figure 6 shows the average cost for end users of P2P transactions by system type. For the transactions going through those FPS systems, the crediting of the payee's account happens in real (or near real) time. The FPS featured here have different ownership/operation models: Pix in Brazil is operated by the central bank; Transfiya in Colombia is operated by the private sector; NIP in Nigeria is operated by a designated company (public private partnership); PromptPay in Thailand is operated by the private sector; Faster Payment Services in the UK is operated by a designated company (public private partnership).

The role of fast payment systems (FPS) is particularly striking. Wherever P2P transactions are processed through FPS, costs are near zero. Transfers made via Pix (Brazil) are free of charge, while costs for other systems such as NIP (Nigeria), and Transfiya (Colombia) remain below 0.64 percent. In contrast, non-FPS transactions can cost as much as 7.25 percent in Brazil, 3.44 percent in Colombia, and 1.2 percent in Thailand. The data provide strong evidence that FPS reduce costs primarily through infrastructure design, by enabling interoperability, instant settlement, overlay services, new initiation channels, and open participation by banks and non-banks alike.

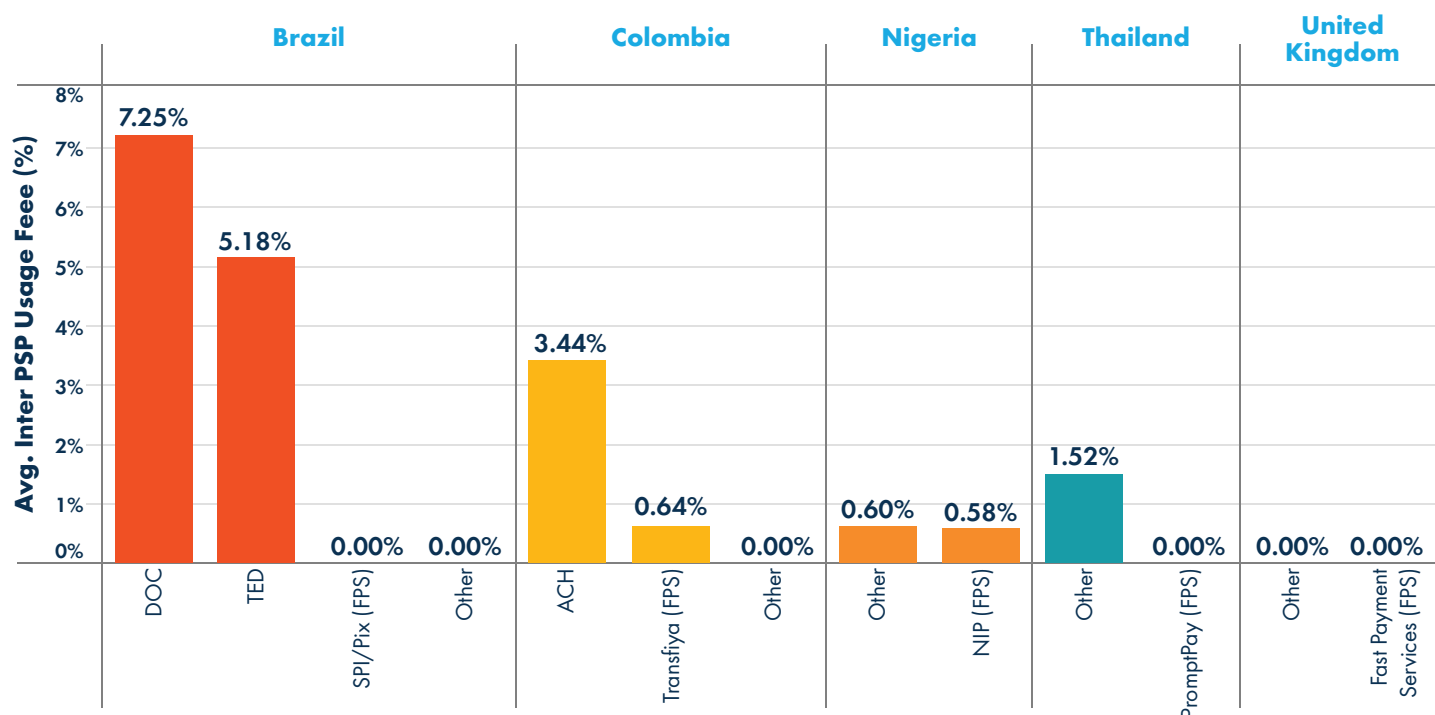
The Impact of Fast Payments

FPS have become an integral part of the payment ecosystems in many countries around the world. According to World Bank data, people and businesses have access to fast payments in about 110 jurisdictions (through domestic and regional FPS) and that number is growing rapidly (see World Bank's Project FASTT). Countries across different geographies, population and economic sizes, are equally embracing fast payments due to the value they have brought to the market: cost efficiencies for end users, instant crediting of the payee's account, ability of banks and non-bank payment service providers to connect to the system, availability of overlay services (e.g. aliases, request-to-pay, confirmation of payee), ability to accommodate a multitude of use cases (for domestic and cross-border payments), transaction channels and underlying payment instruments.

Fast payments can drive financial inclusion, especially in developing economies, where according to the World Bank's Global Findex Database 2021, about 30 percent of adults still do not have a formal transaction account and more than 40 percent do not make or receive digital payments. Countries see fast payments as a building block for the modernization of the financial ecosystem and the digitalization of the economy and government transactions, notably in case of emergencies or natural disasters. Fast payments can also enable more efficient remittances, allowing migrants to reach their families at home in real-time and lowering the cost of these transactions closer to the 2030 target set by the United Nations Sustainable Development Goals of less than 3 percent (compared to the current global average cost of 6.25 percent).

Several countries that have adopted fast payments have started with basic use cases such as P2P and then have gradually expanded the use cases and services around fast payments. The increasing adoption around the world has brought fast payments to new heights, as they hit a record 266 billion transactions in 2023, growing more than 42 percent compared to 2022. This growth is expected to continue at a 17 percent compound annual growth rate in the next years, with the global volume of fast payments expected to reach 575 billion transactions by 2028.

Figure 5 - Share of P2P Transfer Services by Country & by Speed (Inter-PSP)



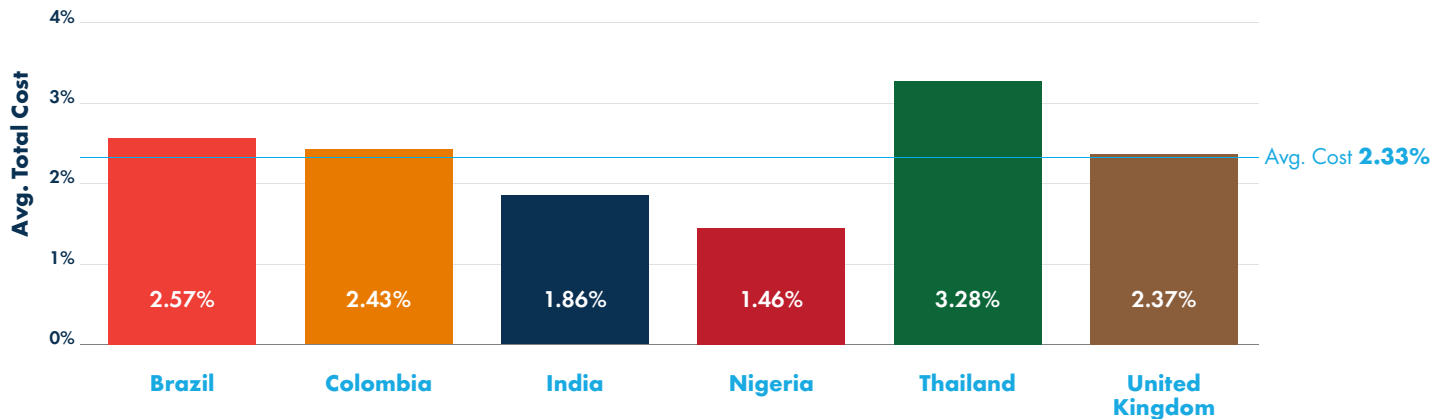
Source: World Bank Domestic Payments Costs Dataset, World Bank and World Bank staff calculations. Figure shows simple averages.

Note: The Other category refers to ACH, e-money switch and RTGS (if used for retail payments).

3.4 P2B Payment Costs

P2B transactions remain more expensive than sending money between individuals. Across the six pilot countries, P2B payments cost an average of 2.33 percent of the transaction amount, ranging from 1.46 percent in Nigeria to 3.28 percent in Thailand. (Figure 6) There is generally a wide variation in costs between P2B payment services across these markets, ranging from 0 to 6 percent of the total transaction value. Yet, data on P2B costs and speed remain fragmented and non-standardized, particularly concerning the MDR, which combines interchange, network, and acquirer fees.

Figure 6 - Average cost of P2B payments, by country



Source: World Bank Domestic Payments Costs Dataset, World Bank and World Bank staff calculations. Figure shows simple averages.

Costs vary sharply across instruments and channels. Debit and credit cards generally offer the most cost-effective payment option, while e-wallets show higher fees in Brazil (5.54 percent, Thailand (3.87 percent), and Colombia (3.61 percent). Cash vouchers are consistently the most expensive payment method, reflecting higher operational and handling costs (Figure 7). Remote P2B transactions, such as payments via links or gateways, are more expensive than in-person POS transactions, highlighting the additional costs associated with online payments.

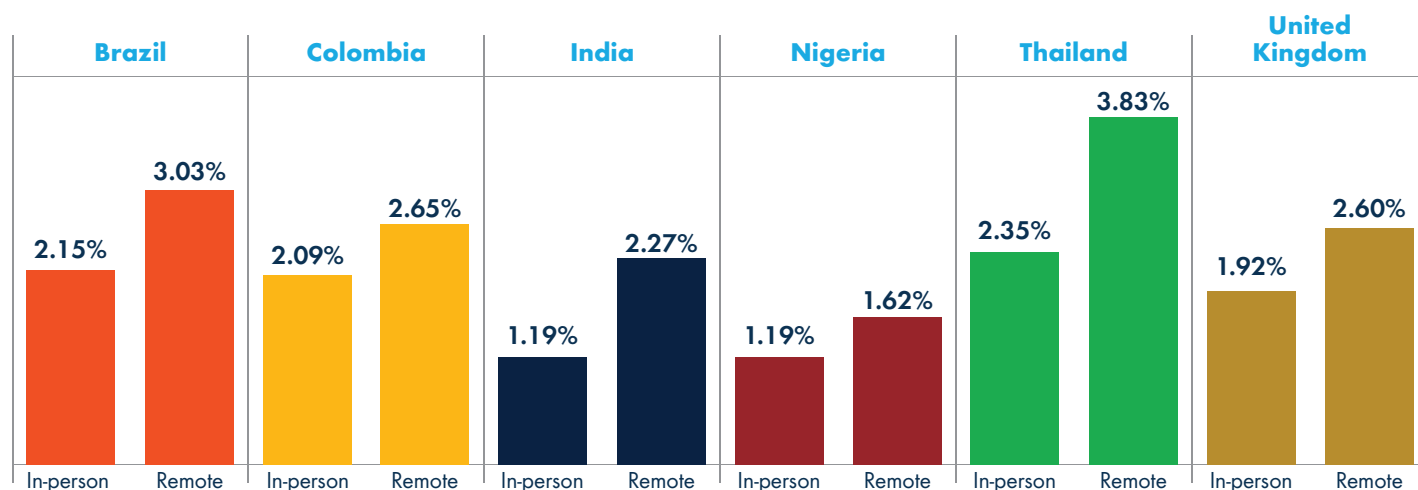
Figure 7 - Average Cost of P2B Payments by Country and Payment Method

Country	Cash-Voucher	Credit Card	Credit Transfer	Debit Card	E-Wallet
Brazil	4.93%	2.86%	2.03%	1.73%	5.54%
Colombia	4.04%	2.35%	2.40%	2.29%	3.61%
India		2.37%	1.61%	1.37%	2.07%
Nigeria		1.42%	1.51%	1.42%	1.47%
Thailand	4.43%	3.44%	2.21%	3.19%	3.87%
United Kingdom		2.47%	1.67%	2.29%	2.47%

Source: World Bank Domestic Payments Costs Dataset, World Bank and World Bank staff calculations. Figure shows simple averages.

Note: Empty cells indicate that the entries are not applicable to P2B payments for the given country.

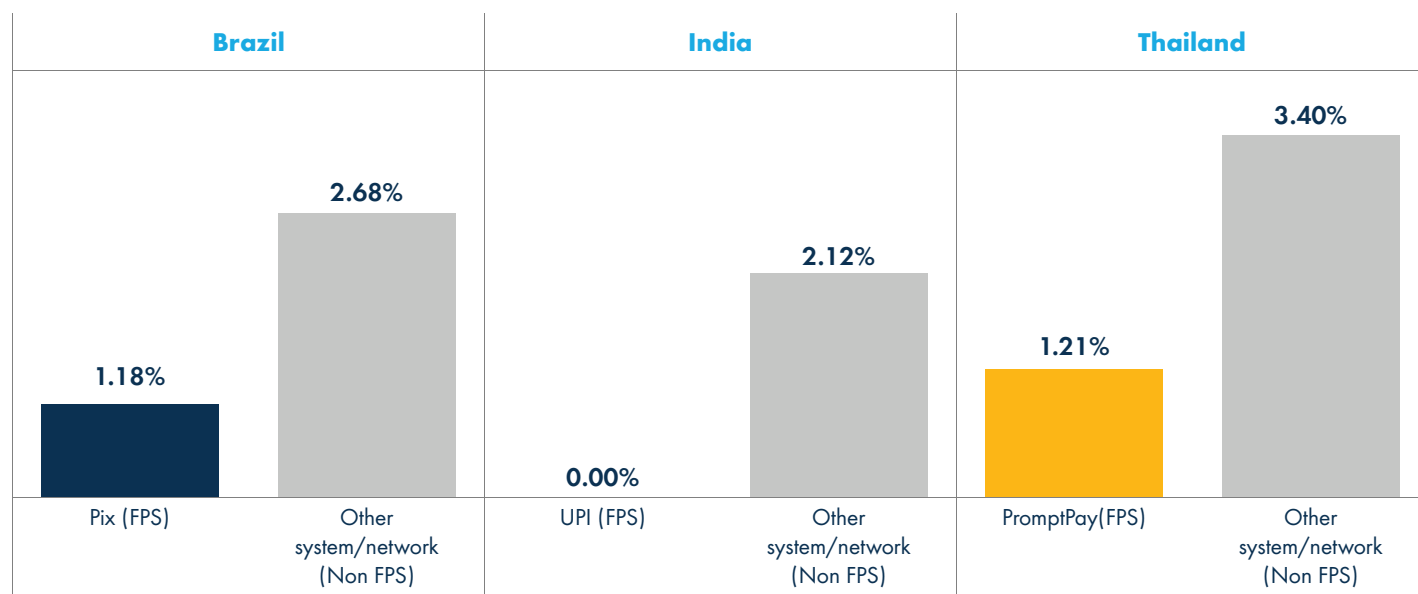
Figure 8 - Average Cost of P2B Payments, by Country and Transaction Channel



Source: World Bank Domestic Payments Costs Dataset, World Bank and World Bank staff calculations. Figure shows simple averages.

Data analysis confirms the transformative impact of FPS for the P2B use case as well (Figure 9). In Brazil, Pix-based merchant payments are roughly 67 percent cheaper than payments made through other systems. In Thailand, PromptPay-based payments are 64 percent cheaper than those using traditional channels. Across all three countries, the introduction of fast payment infrastructure has redefined the economics of merchant payments, allowing small businesses to accept digital payments at minimal cost and supporting broader digitalization of commerce.

Figure 9 - Average Cost of P2B Payments by Payment System



Source: World Bank Domestic Payments Costs Dataset, World Bank and World Bank staff calculations. The table shows simple averages.





CONCLUSION

This pilot study collected data on the pricing and speed of domestic payment services across six markets. For P2P payments, pricing information was largely available, though data on transaction speed and cash withdrawals were more limited. For P2P payments, most markets reported price data, but information on speed and cost structure remained incomplete. These data limitations reflect the broader challenge of transparency and standardization in the domestic payments landscape.

The findings point to significant variations in the cost, speed, and transparency of domestic payment services across countries. For P2P transactions, physical branch transfers remain the most expensive, while digital channels, particularly those supported by fast payment systems, offer near-zero costs. For P2B payments, merchants incur higher costs for remote or online transactions compared with in-store payments. Across the six markets, Brazil stands out as the costliest environment for both P2P and P2B transactions, while the United Kingdom and Nigeria represent the least costly for P2P and P2B transactions, respectively. These differences underscore how infrastructure maturity, market structure, and regulatory frameworks shape affordability.

The pilot also revealed important data collection challenges, particularly for P2B payments, where fee structures are more complex and disclosure practices less consistent. In some cases, providers did not publish any pricing information; in others, fees were reported only as indicative ranges. Collecting and benchmarking data therefore required careful methodological assumptions, such as representative merchant categories and transaction amounts, to ensure cross-country comparability. Despite these constraints, the study demonstrates that systematic, provider-level data collection on domestic payment costs is both feasible and informative, offering critical insights into market efficiency and inclusion.

Three overarching lessons emerge from the analysis. First, access is nearly universal, but usage costs remain uneven. While opening a transaction account is now free in almost all markets, fees associated with withdrawals, transfers, and merchant payments still vary widely, often affecting lower-income users most. Second, speed and interoperability are key determinants of affordability. Markets that have implemented fast payment systems consistently record the lowest costs for both P2P and P2B transactions, illustrating how design and interoperability can improve inclusion outcomes. Third, transparency continues to lag behind innovation. Incomplete disclosure of pricing, especially for withdrawals and merchant fees, limits both consumer choice and regulatory oversight.

Taken together, these findings highlight a central principle: affordability in payments is not only an economic variable, but a reflection of system design, competition, and trust. As access to transaction accounts becomes nearly universal, the focus of reform must shift toward efficiency, transparency, and equity in payment usage.

Looking ahead, the World Bank will continue to expand and institutionalize data collection on domestic payment costs. The scope of coverage will broaden to include countries across all income levels and regions, capturing a wide range of payment ecosystem maturities. The methodology developed under this pilot with any potential improvements will facilitate more efficient replication in future rounds.

Further refinements will include more granular classification of merchant categories, payment instruments, and transaction channels to enhance comparability and analytical depth. Ultimately, this initiative aims to establish a World Bank Global Database on Domestic Payment Costs, modeled on the Remittance Prices Worldwide platform. This global public good will allow policymakers, regulators, and researchers to monitor progress, identify affordability gaps, and design reforms that advance safe, efficient, and inclusive domestic payment systems worldwide.

ANNEX I: PROVIDERS BY COUNTRY

P2P

COUNTRY	BANKS	DIGITAL BANKS	E-MONEY PROVIDERS
BRAZIL	Banco do Brasil	Nubank	MercadoPago
	Itau Unibanco		PicPay
	Caixa Economica Federal		WhatsApp Pay
	Banco Bradesca		
	Banco Santander		
COLOMBIA	Bancolombia	RappiPay	DaviPlata
	Banco Davivienda		Nequi
	Banco de Bogotá		Dale
	BBVA Colombia		MOVii
INDIA	State Bank of India		Mobikwik
	HDFC Bank		Paytm
	ICICI Bank		WhatsApp Pay
	Punjab National Bank		
	Bank of Baroda		
	Canara Bank		
	Union Bank of India		
	Axis Bank		
NIGERIA	Access Bank		Paga
	First Bank of Nigeria		MTN MoMo
	United Bank for Africa		Seam Pay
	Guaranty Trust Bank		
	Fidelity Bank		
	Stanbic IBTC Bank		
	First City Monument Bank		
THAILAND	Bangkok Bank		TrueMoney
	Krungthai Bank		Rabbit LINE Pay
	Kasikorn Thai Bank		ShopeePay
	Siam Commercial Bank		MPay
	Krungsri Bank		
	TMBThanachart Bank		
UNITED KINGDOM	HSBC Holdings	Monzo	Revolut
	Barclays	Starling Bank	PayPal
	Lloyds Banking Group		
	NatWest		

COUNTRY	PSP
BRAZIL	Adyen
	Cielo
	Getnet
	PagSeguro
	PayPal
	Rede (Itau)
	Sicredi
	StoneCo
	Vero
COLOMBIA	Banco Caja Social
	Banco Davivienda
	Banco de Occidente
	Bancolombia
	BBVA
	CredibanCo
	Mercado Pago
	Pagos Redeban
	PayU (via BBVA / Davivienda)
	Scotiabank Colpatría
INDIA	Adyen
	Axis Bank
	Bank of Baroda (BoB Financial)
	Bank of India
	CC Avenue
	HDFC Bank
	ICICI (Fiserv)
	Instamojo
	PayTM
	PayU
	RazorPay
	SBI Payments
	Stripe
NIGERIA	Access Bank
	First Bank Nigeria
	Flutterwave
	Global Accelerex
	GT Bank (via Squad)
	Interswitch (Quickteller Business)
	Paga
	Paystack
	Stanbic Bank
	UBA
	Zenith Bank

COUNTRY	PSP
THAILAND	2C2P Thailand
	Adyen
	Bangkok Bank
	Bank of Ayudhya (Krungsri)
	Kasikorn Bank
	Krungthai Bank / Krungthai Card (KTC)
	PayPal
	Siam Commercial Bank (SCM)
	Stripe
	TMBThanachart Bank
	UOB Thailand
UNITED KINGDOM	Adyen
	Barclays (Barclaycard)
	Cardnet Merchant Services (Lloyds)
	Clover (Fiserv)
	Elavon
	Evo Payments International
	Global Payments
	HSBC Merchant Services
	JP Morgan Commercial Solutions
	Natwest Ty
	PayPal
	Stripe
	WorldPay by FIS

Note: Two card networks (Mastercard and Visa) were included in all countries in the dataset

ANNEX II: GLOSSARY

P2P

CATEGORY	INDICATOR	DEFINITION
TYPE OF PSP	Traditional Bank	Financial institutions licensed to provide checking, savings, and loan issuing services
	Digital Bank	Payment service providers where banking services are delivered online
	E-money Issuers	Non-bank providers that use electronic money as a medium to provide financial services
TYPE OF ACCOUNT	Transaction Account by Banks	The most accessible account for consumers offered by banking institutions
	Mobile Money Account	A specific type of e-money account that operates via a mobile device
	E-money Account	An account that stores and uses electronic money (excluding mobile money) as a medium for transaction, provided by a non-bank payment service provider such as an e-money issuer.
SENDING PAYMENT METHOD	Bank Account (Credit Transfer)	A payment order or sequence of payment orders made for the purpose of placing funds at the disposal of the beneficiary
	E-wallet	A computer device used in some electronic money systems which can contain an IC card or in which IC cards can be inserted
	Mobile Money Account	An account linked to a mobile phone number that allows users to store, send, and receive money using their mobile phones
TRANSACTION CHANNEL	In Person	
	Bank Branch	A physical location where customers can perform banking transactions directly with bank staff
	Remote	
	Call Center	A service center where customers can perform banking transactions or get support via telephone
	Internet	An open worldwide communication infrastructure consisting of interconnected computer networks allowing access to remote information and the exchange of information between computers
	Mobile App	A software application designed to run on mobile devices, allowing users to perform banking transactions remotely

RECEIVING PAYMENT METHOD	USSD	Unstructured Supplementary Service Data, a protocol used by GSM cellular telephones to communicate with the service provider's computers. It is often used for mobile banking services
	Bank Account	A financial account maintained by a bank or other financial institution for a customer
	E-wallet	A computer device used in some electronic money systems which can contain an IC card or in which IC cards can be inserted. It is used to store electronic money and facilitate electronic transactions
	Mobile Money Account	An account linked to a mobile phone number that allows users to store, send, and receive money using their mobile phones
TYPE OF COSTS	Access Fee	The cost of opening and maintaining an account
	Cash Withdrawal Fee	The cost of withdrawing cash charged by the provider
	Intra PSP Usage Fee	The cost of sending a transfer to an account offered by the same provider
	Inter PSP Usage Fee	The cost of sending a transfer to an account offered by a different provider
SPEED OF RECEIVING FUNDS		The time required for domestic transfers to reach the recipients
TYPE OF TRANSACTION	Intra-PSP Transaction	Refers to domestic payment transaction sending to the same provider
	Inter-PSP Transaction	Refers to domestic payment transaction sending to a different provider
PAYMENT SYSTEM	Fast Payment System (FPS)	A fast payment system (also known as instant, real-time, immediate) is a payment system that enables the real-time or near real-time transfer of funds between bank accounts. These systems are designed to provide immediate availability of funds to the recipient, enhancing the efficiency and speed of financial transactions. Fast payment systems are typically used for retail payments and are characterized by their ability to process transactions 24/7, providing instant confirmation and settlement of payments.
	Automated Clearing House (ACH)	An electronic clearing system in which payment orders are exchanged among financial institutions, primarily via magnetic media or telecommunications networks, and then cleared amongst the participants. All operations are handled by a data processing center. An ACH typically clears credit transfers and debit transfers, and in some cases also cheques. See also clearing/clearance.
	Real Time Gross Settlement System (RTGS)	A system which enables the real-time settlement of payments, transfer instructions, or other obligations individually on a transaction-by-transaction basis.
	e-Money Switch	An e-money switch refers to a system or network that facilitates the routing of transaction information for electronic money transactions. It typically involves the processing and routing of transaction data between different financial institutions or entities involved in the electronic money ecosystem. The switch ensures that transaction information is correctly directed to the appropriate parties for authorization, clearing, and settlement.

CATEGORY	INDICATOR	DEFINITION
TYPE OF PSP	Acquirer	The entity or entities that hold(s) deposit accounts for card acceptors (merchants) and to which the card acceptor transmits the data relating to the transaction
	Card Network	The infrastructure and systems that facilitate the processing of card transactions
MERCHANT CATEGORY		The type of business category. Merchant fees and interchange fees can vary based on which industry the business operates in.
PAYMENT METHOD	Bank Account	A financial account maintained by a bank or other financial institution for a customer
	Credit Card	A card indicating that the holder has been granted a line of credit. It enables the holder to make purchases and/or withdraw cash up to a prearranged ceiling
	Debit Card	A card enabling the holder to have his purchases directly charged to funds on his account at a deposit-taking institution
	E-wallet	A computer device used in some electronic money systems which can contain an IC card or in which IC cards can be inserted. It may perform more functions than an IC card
	Cash Voucher	A payment method that allows customers to make online transactions without paying with an electronic payment method. The customer receives a voucher and completes the transaction by paying at a physical location
MERCHANT FEES	Interchange Fee	Fees charged by the card issuing bank (i.e., bank that represents the payer/individual)
	Network Fee (Also known as scheme fee or assessment fee)	Fees charged by the card network.
	Acquirer Fee	Fees charged by the acquirer/processor (i.e., bank/institution that represents the payee/merchant)

TYPE OF COSTS`	Access Fee	<i>The cost of opening and maintaining an account</i>
	Cash Withdrawal Fee	<i>The cost of withdrawing cash charged by the provider</i>
	Intra PSP Usage Fee	<i>The cost of sending a transfer to an account offered by the same provider</i>
	Inter PSP Usage Fee	<i>The cost of sending a transfer to an account offered by a different provider</i>
TRANSACTION CHANNEL	Offline	<i>Transaction made via payment links, payment gateway, or QR code remotely</i>
	Online	<i>Transaction made via POS terminal or QR code in person</i>
SPEED OF RECEIVING FUNDS		<i>The time required for funds to be settled between the acquirer/processor and the merchant, and to ultimately reach the merchant's bank account</i>





1818 H Street NW
Washington, DC 20433 USA
www.worldbank.org
Telephone: +1 202 473-1000

© The World Bank Group, 2025